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System for measuring and calibrating touch, force, and haptic output at a touch sensor

Abstract

A touch assembly includes: an outer tip; an inner tip; a circuit board; a vibration sensor; and a spring element. The outer tip includes a distal end defining an outer contact surface. The inner tip: is arranged concentrically within the outer tip; extends from the distal end of the outer tip; and defines an inner contact surface. The circuit board is arranged over a proximal end of the outer tip. The spring element: is interposed between the circuit board and the inner tip; couples the inner tip to a reference potential; and is configured to, during a haptic feedback cycle at a touch sensor in response to application of the inner tip toward the touch sensor, yield to locate the inner contact surface coplanar with the outer contact surface. The vibration sensor is arranged on the circuit board and configured to output vibration signals during the haptic feedback cycle.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/454,510, filed on 24 Mar. 2023, which is hereby incorporated in its entirety by this reference. (2) This application is related to U.S. Non-Provisional application Ser. No. 18/207,603, filed on 8 Jun. 2023, Ser. No. 18/200,304, filed on 22 May 2023, and Ser. No. 18/141,317, filed on 28 Apr. 2023, each of which is hereby incorporated in its entirety by this reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This invention relates generally to the field of touch sensors and more specifically to a new and useful measurement and calibration system **100** in the field of touch sensors.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

- (1) FIG. 1 is a schematic representation of a system;
- (2) FIG. 2 is a schematic representation of the system;
- (3) FIG. 3 is a schematic representation of the system;
- (4) FIG. 4 is a schematic representation of the system;
- (5) FIG. 5 is a schematic representation of the system;
- (6) FIG. 6 is a schematic representation of the system; and
- (7) FIG. 7 is a schematic representation of the system.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(8) The following description of embodiments of the invention is not intended to limit the invention to these embodiments but rather to enable a person skilled in the art to make and use this invention. Variations, configurations, implementations, example implementations, and examples described herein are optional and are not exclusive to the variations, configurations, implementations, example implementations, and examples they describe. The invention described herein can include any and all permutations of these variations, configurations, implementations, example implementations, and examples.

1. System

(9) As shown in FIG. 1, a system **100** for characterizing touch and haptics responses of surfaces includes a tip assembly **110** including: an outer tip **120**; a conductive inner tip **130**; a circuit board **140**; a vibration sensor **142**; and a spring element **150**.

(10) The outer tip **120** includes: a distal end; an aperture **122** proximal the distal end; and an outer contact surface **126** arranged about the aperture **122**.

(11) The conductive inner tip **130**: is arranged concentrically within the outer tip **120**; extends through the aperture **122** of the outer tip **120**; and includes an inner contact surface **136**.

(12) The circuit board **140** is arranged adjacent a proximal end of the outer tip **120**.

(13) The vibration sensor **142**: is arranged on the circuit board **140**; and is configured to output vibration signals representing vibrations transferred into the outer tip **120** and into the conductive inner tip **130**.

(14) The spring element **150**: is interposed between the circuit board **140** and the conductive inner tip **130**; couples the conductive inner tip **130** to a reference potential; and is configured to yield responsive to a force applied to the conductive inner tip **130** that translates the conductive inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120**.

(15) The tip assembly **110** is operable in a first configuration during application of the conductive inner tip **130** on a touch sensor surface of a touch sensor at a first selection force, the inner contact surface **136** offset vertically from the outer contact surface **126** and the conductive inner tip **130** effecting electrical values across drive and sense electrodes in the touch sensor in the first configuration.

(16) The tip assembly **110** is also operable in a second configuration during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor in response to application of the conductive inner tip **130** on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at a second selection force greater than the first selection force, the inner contact surface **136** coplanar with the outer contact surface **126** and the outer tip **120** and the conductive inner tip **130** transferring vibrations from the touch sensor surface into the vibration sensor **142** in the second configuration.

2. Applications

(17) Generally, the system **100** can—in conjunction with a touch sensor—execute a single measurement routine (e.g., touch response measurement, haptics intensity measurement) in order to selectively: apply (e.g., drag) a conductive inner tip **130** of a tip assembly **110** across regions of a

touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at a first selection force (e.g., between 10 grams-force and 35 grams-force) to measure touch (e.g., capacitive touch) and force response from the touch sensor; or apply (e.g., couple) an outer tip **120** of the tip assembly **110** across regions of the touch sensor surface at a second selection force (e.g., greater than 50 grams-force)—greater than the first selection force—to measure haptic response (e.g., haptic intensity) across the touch sensor surface during execution of a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor. Thus, rather than manually changing measurement tips (e.g., haptics measurement tip, touch measurement tip) to measure touch and haptic response at the touch sensor, the system **100** can autonomously transition the tip assembly **110** between a touch mode and a haptics mode to capture touch, force, and haptics data from the touch sensor within a single measurement routine.

(18) In particular, the system **100** can include: a probe arranged over a touch sensor; and a tip assembly **110** coupled to the probe and configured to 1) effect electrical values across drive and sense electrodes (e.g., capacitive touch sensors, capacitive force sensors) at the touch sensor and 2) detect vibrations across the touch sensor surface during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor. The tip assembly **110** can include an outer tip **120** including: an inner channel; and an outer contact surface **126** (e.g., annular elastomeric material structure) arranged at a distal end of the outer tip **120**. Additionally, the tip assembly **110** can include a conductive inner tip **130**: arranged concentrically within the inner channel of the outer tip **120**; extending from a distal end of the outer tip **120**; and including an inner contact surface **136** (e.g., circular conductive surface).

(19) The tip assembly **110** also includes: a circuit board **140** arranged over a proximal end of the outer tip **120** to enclose the inner tip **130** within the channel of the outer tip **120**; and a vibration sensor **142** arranged on the circuit board **140** and configured to detect vibration signals transferred from the outer tip **120** and the conductive inner tip **130**. The system **100** further includes a spring element **150** interposed between the conductive inner tip **130** and a circuit board **140** arranged over the outer tip **120**. More specifically, the spring element **150** is configured to: in response to application of the first selection force to the inner tip **130**, maintain the inner contact surface **136** vertically offset from the outer contact surface **126** to operate the tip assembly **110** in the touch mode; and, in response to application of the second selection force—greater than the first selection force—to the inner tip **130**, vertically translate the conductive inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120** to locate the inner contact surface **136** coplanar with the outer contact surface **126** and operate the tip assembly **110** in the haptics mode. Thus, the system **100** can transition the tip assembly **110** from the touch mode to the haptics mode

(20) In one example, system **100** can: drive a voltage signal across the inner tip **130**; and drive the probe at a first target selection force (e.g., 10 gram-force to 35 gram-force) to apply (e.g., drag) the inner tip **130** across regions of the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor. The system **100** can also couple the inner tip **130** to a virtual ground and drive the probe at a second target selection force (e.g., 40 gram-force-100 gram-force), greater than the first target selection force to: vertically translate the inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120**; couple the outer tip **120** to a particular region on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor; and trigger a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor. Thus, the system **100** can, during a measurement routine, operate both: in a touch mode to induce touch response and force response across regions of the touch sensor; and a haptics mode to record haptic intensities—during a haptic feedback cycle—across regions of the touch sensor.

(21) In another example, during a first time period in a measurement routine, the system **100** can: trigger the probe to apply the inner tip **130**, at a first target selection force (e.g., 10 gram-force-35 gram-force), on a first region of the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor; drive a voltage signal across the inner tip **130** to induce variations in electrical values across an array of drive and sense electrode pairs at the touch sensor; and drive (e.g., drag) the probe across a sequence of locations in the first region of the touch sensor surface. Accordingly, during the first time period, the touch sensor can then: capture a sequence of touch images representing magnitudes of forces detected on the touch sensor surface; and transmit the sequence of touch images to the system **100**.

(22) Additionally, during a second time period following the measurement routine, the system **100** can: drive the probe to a target haptic location in the first region on the touch sensor surface; and trigger the probe, at a second target selection force greater than the first target selection force (e.g., 40 gram-force-100 gram-force), to laterally translate the inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120** and apply direct contact of the outer tip **120** and the inner tip **130** at the touch sensor surface. Accordingly, during the second time period, the touch sensor can then, in response to applying the second target selection force at the first region on the touch sensor surface, execute a haptic feedback cycle to oscillate the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor. The system **100** can then: record a haptic feedback intensity (e.g., peak to peak intensities) at the touch sensor surface during the haptic feedback cycle; generate a vibration image representing haptic response at the first region of the touch sensor surface; fuse the sequence of touch images and the vibration images into a response map; and store the response map in local memory of the system **100**.

(23) Therefore, the system **100** can then: retrieve the response map representing touch, force, and haptic response of the touch sensor from local memory; calibrate input force thresholds across an area of the touch sensor based on the response map and thus compensate for manufacturing variance and manufacturing defects within the touch sensor in order to enable more accurate and repeatable detection and responses to inputs across the touch sensor surface as a function of applied force; and calibrate haptic feedback response across regions of a touch sensor surface based on the response map and thus compensate for haptic signal interference across the touch sensor surface generated during concurrent actuation of two or more haptic feedback modules.

3. Touch Sensor

(24) As shown in FIG. **4**, the touch sensor includes: a circuit board **140**; a cover layer arranged above the circuit board **140** and defining a touch sensor surface; a touch sensor layer interposed between a top side of the circuit board **140** and the cover layer; a force sensor layer arranged below a bottom side of the circuit board **140**; and a controller **190** configured to read electrical signals (e.g., voltages) from the touch sensor layer and the force sensor layer. The touch sensor layer includes a first array of drive and sense electrode pairs patterned across the touch sensor layer defining a touch input sensor. The force sensor layer includes a second array of drive and sense electrode pairs patterned across the force sensor layer defining a force input sensor.

(25) In this configuration, application of a localized force to the touch sensor surface drives sense electrodes in the force sensor layer into contact with drive electrodes in the force sensor array to: reduce an electrode gap between sense electrodes and drive electrodes in the second array of drive and sense electrode pairs; increase capacitance across these drive and sense electrode pairs (e.g., manifesting as increased voltages at the sense electrodes when the drive electrodes are driven to a reference potential) as a function of (e.g., proportional to) the magnitude of the applied force.

(26) Accordingly, the controller **190** is configured to: drive the first array of drive and sense electrode pairs (e.g., to a reference potential); read a first set of electrical values from the array of sense electrodes in the first array of drive and sense electrode pairs; and interpret a touch input applied at a particular location on the touch sensor surface based on differences between the first set of electrical values from baseline touch electrical values at the touch sensor. The controller **190** is also configured to: drive the second array set of drive and sense electrode pairs (e.g., to a reference potential); read a second set of electrical values from the array of sense electrodes in the second array of drive and sense electrode pairs; and interpret a force magnitude for the touch input applied at the particular location on the touch sensor surface based on differences between the second set of electrical values from baseline force electrical values at the touch sensor.

(27) One variation of the touch sensor can also include: a haptic actuator (e.g., magnet+coil, LRA, piezo, ERM, solenoids) arranged below the circuit board **140**; and configured to oscillate the touch sensor surface. Accordingly, the controller **190** is also configured to, in response to application of a target force magnitude (e.g., 200 gram-force) on the touch sensor surface, trigger the haptic actuator to oscillate the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor. In one example, the haptic

actuator includes: a magnetic element arranged below the circuit board **140**; and a set of inductor layers arranged within the circuit board **140** and defining a multi-layer inductor facing the magnetic element and configured to magnetically couple the magnetic element to oscillate the touch sensor surface. Accordingly, the system **100** can: apply a sequence of target force magnitudes (e.g., varying force magnitudes) at the touch sensor surface; induce haptic feedback responses (e.g., deep-click response, double click response, click response) at the touch sensor according to the applied target force magnitudes; and measure haptic feedback output from the touch sensor during execution of the haptic feedback cycles.

(28) Thus, the system **100** can: receive a sequence of touch sensors, each capable of outputting variations of touch, force, and haptic response; and measure combinations of touch, force and/or haptics output at the sequence of touch sensors without changing tips at the system **100**. For example, the system **100** can: measure touch output at a first touch sensor (e.g., touch only touch sensor) in the sequence of touch sensors; measure force inputs at a second touch sensor (e.g., force only touch sensor) in the sequence of touch sensors; measure touch+force outputs from a third touch sensor (e.g., touch and force only touch sensor) in the sequence of touch sensors; measure touch+haptics outputs at a fourth touch sensor (e.g., touch and haptics only touch sensor) in the sequence of touch sensors; and measure touch+force+haptic outputs from a fifth touch sensor in the sequence of touch sensors.

4. System

(29) As shown in FIGS. **1** and **4**, the system **100** includes: a controller **190**; a touch sensor receptacle **132** configured to receive and locate the touch sensor; a probe; a tip assembly **110** coupled to a first end of the probe; a boom supporting the probe and configured to drive the tip assembly **110** at the probe toward the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor; an actuation subsystem **100** configured to scan the probe laterally and longitudinally across the touch sensor surface; and a force (or “pressure”) sensor configured to detect a force magnitude of the probe applied normal to the touch sensor surface.

(30) 4.1 Measurement Tip Assembly

(31) Generally, the system **100** includes a tip assembly **110** including: an outer tip **120**; an inner tip **130** formed of a conductive material (e.g., copper) and nested within the outer tip **120**; circuit board **140** including a vibration sensor **142** arranged over the outer tip **120** and the inner tip **130**; and a spring element **150** arranged within the inner tip **130** and coupling the inner tip **130** to the circuit board **140**. In particular the system **100** can: trigger the probe to apply the tip assembly **110**—at a first target selection force (e.g., 10 gram-force-35 gram-force)—at a first region on the touch sensor surface to maintain the tip assembly **110** in a touch mode operation in which the inner tip **130** assembly **110** directly contacts the touch sensor surface; and/or trigger the probe to apply the tip assembly **110**—at a second target selection force (e.g., 40 gram-force-200 gram-force) greater than the first target selection force—at the first region on the touch sensor surface to maintain the tip assembly **110** in a haptic mode operation in which the inner tip **130** and the outer tip **120** directly contact the touch sensor surface.

(32) 4.1.1 Inner Tip+Outer Tip

(33) In one implementation, the system **100** includes a tip assembly **110**: coupled to a distal end of the probe; and including an outer tip **120** and an inner tip **130**. The outer tip **120**: defines a first cavity within the outer tip **120**; includes a flange arranged within the first cavity and radially extending within the first cavity; and defines an outer tip **120** contact surface (e.g., flat, circular contact surface) including an elastomeric material (e.g., rubber) approximately 9 millimeters-11 millimeters in diameter. The inner tip **130**: is arranged within the first cavity of the outer tip **120**; defines a second cavity within the inner tip **130**; includes a ledge radially extending about a top end of the inner tip **130** and configured to rest on the flange of the first cavity when the inner tip **130** is nested within the outer tip **120**; and defines an inner tip **130** contact surface (e.g., smooth, flat, circular contact surface) formed of a conductive material (e.g., copper) approximately 6

millimeters-8 millimeters in diameter.

(34) In this implementation, the inner tip **130** is arranged within the outer tip **120** such that the inner tip **130** vertically translates within the outer tip **120**; and is configured to, in response to application of a force at the inner tip **130** surface, locate the inner tip **130** surface flush with the outer tip **120** surface. Accordingly, the system **100** can: drive the probe to apply (e.g., drag) the inner tip **130** across regions of the touch sensor surface; and drive the probe—at a target selection force—to locate the inner tip **130** surface flush with the outer tip **120** surface at a particular region on the touch sensor surface. The elastomeric material at the outer tip **120** contact surface is configured to grip the touch sensor surface and prevent unwanted movement of the tip assembly **110** during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor in order to transfer vibrations across the touch sensor surface through the outer tip **120** toward the vibration sensor **142**.

(35) 4.1.2 Concentric Alignment

(36) In one implementation, the tip assembly **110** includes the inner tip **130**: arranged concentrically within a channel of the outer tip **120**; vertically constrained within the channel (e.g., cylindrical channel) of the outer tip **120**; and configured to vertically (e.g., linearly) translate within the channel of the outer tip **120** responsive to an applied force (e.g., 50 grams-force) at the inner tip **130**. In this implementation, the inner tip **130** can include: a receptacle **132** (e.g., cylindrical reservoir) including a base **134** (e.g., circular base) that defines the inner contact surface **136**; and a lip **133** (e.g., support structure) arranged (e.g., integrated) about a top end of the receptacle **132**. For example, the receptacle **132** can: define cylindrical volume of a diameter that cooperates with a diameter of the channel of the outer tip **120**; and includes a cylindrical base formed of a conductive material that defines a circular inner contact surface **136** that is concentric to the outer contact surface **126** of the outer tip **120**.

(37) Additionally, in this implementation, the outer tip **120** includes: the channel defining an inner wall (e.g., cylindrical inner wall) extending from the proximal end to the distal end of the outer tip **120**; and a platform **124** (e.g., annular platform) arranged about the inner wall and configured to support (or “rest on”) the lip **133** of the receptacle **132**—of the inner tip **130**—to concentrically locate the inner tip **130** within the channel of the outer tip **120**. In particular, the lip **133** of the receptacle **132** is supported by (or “rests on”) the platform **124** about the inner channel of the outer tip **120** to: locate the lip **133** of the receptacle **132** at an offset distance (e.g., 10 millimeters) from the proximal end of the outer tip **120**; and locate the base **134** of the receptacle **132**—and therefore the inner contact surface **136**—extending from the aperture **122** arranged at the distal end of the outer tip **120**. Thus, responsive to an applied force (e.g., 50 grams-force) at the base **134** of the inner tip **130**, the inner tip **130** can: vertically translate within the channel toward the proximal end of the outer tip **120**; and locate the inner contact surface **136** of the inner tip **130** coplanar with the outer contact surface **126** of the outer tip **120**.

(38) In one implementation, the tip assembly **110** can further include: a circuit board **140** arranged over the proximal end of the outer tip **120** to enclose the inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120**; and a spring element **150** arranged within the receptacle **132** of the inner tip **130** and interposed between the base **134** of the receptacle **132** and a bottom side of the circuit board **140**. For example, the spring element **150** can define a coiled metallic structure: vertically interposed between the base **134** of the receptacle **132** and the bottom side of the circuit board **140**; including a first end configured to electrically couple the base **134**—formed of a conductive material—of the receptacle **132** of the inner tip **130**; and a second end, opposite the first end, coupled to a via on a bottom side of the circuit board **140**. In this example, the inner tip **130** can further include: a guide ring **152** (e.g., annular structure) arranged within the receptacle **132**; and configured to vertically constrain the spring element **150** within the receptacle **132** of the inner tip **130**.

(39) Accordingly, the spring element **150**: forms an electrical connection (e.g., to virtual ground) between the inner tip **130** and the circuit board **140**; and defines an uncompressed configuration, such as responsive to absence of an applied force at the inner tip **130**, to locate the inner tip **130**

extending from the distal end of the outer tip **120**; and defines a compressed configuration, such as responsive to an applied force (e.g., 50 grams-force) at the inner tip **130**, to vertically translate the inner tip **130** within the passage of the outer tip **120** and locate the inner contact surface **136** coplanar with the outer contact surface **126**.

(40) For example, the spring element **150** is configured to, in response to application of a first selection force (e.g., less than 50 grams-force) at the inner tip **130**, yield to: offset the lip **133** of the receptacle **132** from the platform **124** to partially translate the conductive inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120**; and locate the inner contact surface **136** of the conductive inner tip **130** vertically offset from the outer contact surface **126** of the outer tip **120**. Therefore, in a first configuration (e.g., a touch mode), the tip assembly **110** can maintain the inner tip **130** vertically offset from the outer tip **120**, thereby enabling the system **100** to navigate (e.g., drag) the inner tip **130** across a touch sensor surface of a touch sensor.

(41) In another example, the spring element **150** is configured to, in response to application of a second selection force (e.g., greater than 50 grams-force), greater than the first selection force, yield to: offset the lip **133** of the receptacle **132** from the platform **124** to vertically translate the conductive inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120**; couple the lip **133** of the receptacle **132** to a bottom side of the circuit board **140**; and locate the inner contact surface **136** of the conductive inner tip **130** coplanar with the outer contact surface **126** of the outer tip **120**. Therefore, in a second configuration (e.g., a haptics mode), the tip assembly **110** can maintain the inner tip **130** and the outer tip **120** along a single plane over the touch sensor surface, thereby enabling the system **100** to transfer vibrations across the touch sensor surface—such as during a haptic feedback cycle—to a vibration sensor **142** arranged on the circuit board **140**.

(42) 4.1.3 Printed Circuit Board

(43) In one implementation, the system **100** includes a circuit board **140** (e.g., flexible substrate, rigid multi-layer substrate): coupled to the inner tip **130** and the outer tip **120**; and including a vibration sensor **142** arranged over the inner tip **130** and the outer tip **120** and configured to detect haptic intensities applied at the inner tip **130** and the outer tip **120**. During operation, the touch sensor can trigger a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor surface—in direct contact with the outer tip **120** and the inner tip **130**—and thus transfer haptic intensities from the contact surface to the vibration sensor **142** at the circuit board **140**. In this implementation, the system **100** includes the circuit board **140** coupled to the controller **190** and can thus retrieve haptic intensities recorded at the vibration sensor **142**.

(44) For example, the system **100** can include a wired connection between the circuit board **140** and the controller **190**. In another example, shown in FIG. 3, the system **100** includes the circuit board **140** including a tail extending from the tip assembly **110** and connected to the outer tip **120** the controller **190**.

(45) Additionally, the system **100**: includes the circuit board **140** coupled (i.e., electrically coupled) to the conductive material at the inner tip **130**; and is configured to transmit electrical signals (e.g., voltage signals) to the inner tip **130** in order to generate a charged surface across the inner tip **130** contact surface. Accordingly, the system **100** can also couple the inner tip **130** to a reference potential (e.g., virtual ground) in order to cease the charged surface across the inner tip **130** contact surface. Thus, the system **100** can selectively engage the inner tip **130** in a charged mode or a neutral mode during a measurement routine.

(46) In one example, the system **100**: includes the circuit board **140** directly coupled to the inner tip **130**, such as coupled via wires to the inner tip **130** and/or coupled to the inner tip **130** via the spring element **150** arranged within the inner tip **130**; and can couple the inner tip **130** (e.g., via the controller **190** module) to the reference potential (e.g., virtual ground) via wired connection of the circuit board **140** to the inner tip **130**.

(47) In another example, the system **100**: includes the circuit board **140** directly coupled to the inner tip **130**, such as coupled via wires to the inner tip **130** and/or coupled to the inner tip **130** via

the spring element **150** arranged within the inner tip **130**; includes a bottom side of the circuit board **140** including a conductive surface coupled to a virtual ground; and is configured to couple (e.g., directly contact) the top end of the inner tip **130** responsive to application of a force at the inner tip **130** resulting in vertical translation of the inner tip **130** toward the bottom side of the circuit board **140**.

(48) Accordingly, the system **100** can: drive an electrical signal (e.g., voltage signal) across the inner tip **130** to induce a charged surface across the inner tip **130** contact surface, thus affecting electrical values across the touch sensor layer at the touch sensor; couple the inner tip **130** to a virtual ground to discontinue (or “cut off”) the charged surface across the inner tip **130** contact surface; read a set of vibration intensities from the vibration sensor **142**; and generate a vibration image representing haptic intensities at a particular region on the touch sensor surface based on the set of vibration intensities.

(49) 4.1.4 Spring Element

(50) In one implementation, the system **100** includes the spring element **150** (e.g., spiral metallic structure): vertically arranged within the second cavity of the inner tip **130**; defining a bottom end coupled to a bottom end of the probe; and defining a top end coupled to the bottom surface of the circuit board **140**. In this implementation, the spring element **150**: locates the inner tip **130** at a vertical offset from the outer tip **120** (i.e., maintains the inner tip **130** protruding outwardly from the outer tip **120**); and is configured to, responsive to application of a force at the inner tip **130**, vertically translate the inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120**, thus reducing an offset distance between the inner tip **130** contact surface and the outer tip **120** contact surface.

(51) Accordingly, the system **100** includes the spring element **150** formed at a target stiffness (e.g., spring constant) to define a first target force threshold (e.g., 40 gram-force-50 gram-force) configured to: locate the inner tip **130** vertically offset from the outer tip **120** (i.e., the inner tip **130** protruding outwardly from the outer tip **120**) responsive to application of a force below the first target force threshold; and compress the spring element **150**—thus translating the inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120**—to locate the inner tip **130** contact surface flush with the outer tip **120** contact surface responsive to application of a force above the first target force threshold. Thus, the system **100** can: drive the probe at a first target selection force, less than the target force threshold, to apply the inner tip **130** at a particular region on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor; and drive the probe at a second target selection force, greater than the target force threshold, to apply the inner tip **130** and the outer tip **120** at the particular region on the touch sensor surface.

(52) For example, the system **100** can: trigger the probe to apply the tip assembly **110**—at a first target selection force (e.g., 10 gram-force-35 gram-force)—to a particular region at the touch sensor surface such that the inner tip **130** protrudes outwardly from the outer tip **120** and thus remains in direct contact with the touch sensor surface; and trigger the probe to apply the tip assembly **110**—at a second target selection force (e.g., 40 gram-force-200 gram-force) greater than the first target selection force—to the particular region at the touch sensor surface such that the inner tip **130** vertically translates within the outer tip **120** to locate the inner tip **130** contact surface flush with the outer tip **120** contact surface at the particular region.

(53) Therefore, the system **100** can: operate the tip assembly **110** in a touch mode in which the inner tip **130** directly contacts the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor during a first time period in a measurement routine; or operate the tip assembly **110** in a haptic mode in which both the inner tip **130** and the outer tip **120** directly contact the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor during a second time period in the measurement routine.

(54) In another implementation, the spring element **150** includes a foam material (e.g., conductive foam material): interposed between the base **134** of the inner tip **130** and the circuit board **140**; and configured to yield (e.g., compress) to translate the inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120** responsive to an applied force at the inner tip **130**; and electrically coupling the inner tip **130** to the circuit board **140**.

(55) In one variation, the tip assembly **100** includes: the spring element **150** formed of a non-conductive material; and the inner contact surface **136** can be formed of a conductive material (e.g., copper) externally connected to a reference potential.

(56) 4.1.5 Vibration Sensor

(57) In one implementation, the system **100** includes a vibration sensor **142** (e.g., an accelerometer): arranged on the circuit board **140** coupled to the proximal end of the outer tip **120**; and configured to detect vibrations from the outer tip **120** and the inner tip **130** arranged within the outer tip **120**. For example, the vibration sensor **142** can define a multi-dimensional accelerometer configured to detect vibrations: horizontal to a vibration plane (e.g., X, Y plane) at the distal end of the outer tip **120**; and vertical to the vibration plane (e.g., Z-axis) at the distal end of the outer tip **120**.

(58) In this implementation, the outer tip **120** can include: a first support region arranged at the proximal end of the outer tip **120**; a second support region, opposite the first support region, arranged at the proximal end of the outer tip **120**; and the channel interposed between the first support region and the second support region. Additionally, the circuit board **140** can include: a first board section extending over (or “supported by”) the first support region of the outer tip **120**; and a second board section, opposite the first board section, extending over (or “supported by”) the second support region of the outer tip **120**. In one example, the tip assembly **110** can include: a first fastener coupling the first board section of the circuit board **140** to the first support region of the outer tip **120**; and a second fastener coupling the second board section of the circuit board **140** to the second support region of the outer tip **120**.

(59) The circuit board **140** also includes a center board section: interposed between the first board section and the second board section; and extending over the channel of the outer tip **120** to enclose the conductive inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120**. In this implementation, the vibration sensor **142**: is arranged on the center board section of the circuit board **140**; and is configured to detect vibration signals transferred from the outer tip **120** and the inner tip **130**. More specifically, the vibration sensor **142** is configured to detect vibration signals: transferred from the conductive inner tip **130** to the center board section of the circuit board **140**; and transferred from the outer tip **120** to the first board section and the second board section of the circuit board **140**.

(60) Accordingly, in response to application of the inner tip **130** toward the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at the second selection force (e.g., greater than 50 grams-force), the tip assembly **110** is configured to: vertically translate the inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120** to couple the center board section of the circuit board **140**; and couple the outer contact surface **126** and the inner contact surface **136** to the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor. Therefore, during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor to oscillate the touch sensor surface, vibrations across the touch sensor surface are transferred across the outer tip **120** and inner tip **130** toward the vibration sensor **142** arranged on the circuit board **140**.

(61) 4.1.6 Enclosure+Probe Coupling

(62) In one implementation, the system **100** includes: the tip assembly **110** coupled to a distal end of the probe; and a spacer interposed between the tip assembly **110** and the distal end of the probe. In this implementation, the spacer: is formed of a compressible material (e.g., gel, silicone); and is configured to deflect (or “compress”) responsive to application of haptic intensities at the inner tip **130** contact surface and the outer tip **120** contact surface of the tip assembly **110**.

(63) Thus, the system **100** can: drive the probe—at a first selection force greater than the target force threshold—to apply the tip assembly **110** at a first region on the touch sensor surface in order to trigger a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor; transfer haptic intensities applied at the tip assembly **110** toward the spacer, thus enabling the tip assembly **110** to freely oscillate during the haptic feedback cycle; and read a set of haptic feedback intensities from the vibration sensor **142** during the haptic feedback cycle.

(64) Additionally or alternatively, the system **100** can include a clamp coupling the tip assembly

110 to the distal end of the probe.

(65) In one implementation, the system **100** further includes: an interface **170** configured to couple a distal end of a probe; and an enclosure **172** coupled to the interface **170** (e.g., via fasteners) and containing the tip assembly **110**. In this implementation, the tip assembly **110**: is partially contained within the enclosure **172**; and includes the outer tip **120** and the inner tip **130** extending from a bottom end of the enclosure **172**. The tip assembly **110** further includes: a top cover **174** arranged over the circuit board **140** and the vibration sensor **142**; and a spacer element **176** interposed between the interface **170** and the top cover **174** of the tip assembly **110** and configured to dampen vibrations transferred from the interface **170** to the vibration sensor **142**. Therefore, the tip assembly **110** can: dampen external vibrations, such as from navigating the tip assembly **110** across the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor via the probe; and isolate vibrations across the touch sensor surface, such as during a haptic feedback cycle, transferred to the vibration sensor **142** across the outer tip **120** and the inner tip **130**.

(66) 4.1.7 Contact Surface+Touch Sensor Surface

(67) In one implementation, the outer contact surface **126**: defines an annular contact surface about a tip axis at the distal end of the outer tip **120**; and is formed of an elastomeric material (e.g., rubber) configured to maintain contact with the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor during a haptic feedback cycle. Additionally, the inner contact surface **136**: defines a circular contact surface concentrically aligned within the annular contact surface of the outer tip **120**; and is formed of a smooth conductive material (e.g., copper) configured to effect electrical values across drive and sense electrode pairs at the touch sensor.

(68) During application of the tip assembly **110**—in the touch mode configuration—toward the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at the first selection force, the smooth conductive material couples the touch sensor surface at the first selection force. The touch sensor can then capture a touch image representing detected force magnitudes across the touch sensor surface during application of the inner tip **130** across the touch sensor surface at the first selection force. Alternatively, during application of the tip assembly **110**—in the haptic mode configuration—toward the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at the second selection force, the elastomeric material couples the touch sensor surface at the second selection force and therefore prevents the tip assembly **110** from sliding across the touch sensor surface during a haptic feedback cycle oscillating the touch sensor surface. The system **100** can then, during the haptic feedback cycle, capture a first haptic waveform from the vibration sensor **142** representing detected vibrations (e.g., peak-to-peak vibrations) across the touch sensor surface during the haptic feedback cycle.

(69) In one example, the inner contact surface **136** defines a smooth conductive surface (e.g., copper) configured to effect electrical values across drive and sense electrode pairs at the touch sensor. Additionally, the outer contact surface **126** defines an elastomeric surface (e.g., rubber) configured to, during a haptic feedback cycle at a touch sensor, grip the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor. Accordingly, the tip assembly **110** is operable in the touch configuration, during application of the inner tip **130** toward the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at the first selection force: including the smooth conductive surface vertically offset from the elastomeric surface; and configured to effect electrical values across the drive and sense electrode pairs at the touch sensor during coupling of the smooth conductive surface to the touch sensor surface. Furthermore, the tip assembly **110** is operable in the haptic configuration, during the haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor in response to application of the conductive inner tip **130** toward the touch sensor surface at the second selection force: including the smooth conductive surface coplanar with the elastomeric surface; and configured to transfer vibrations across the touch sensor surface to the vibration sensor **142** during coupling of the smooth conductive surface and the elastomeric surface to the touch sensor surface.

(70) Therefore, the tip assembly **110** can concurrently: contact the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor to effect electrical values across drive and sense electrode pairs at the touch sensor; and

contact the touch sensor surface to transfer vibrations across the touch sensor surface to the vibration sensor **142**.

(71) In one variation, the inner contact surface **136** defines a foam material (e.g., perforated foam) configured to contact the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor to effect electrical values across an array of force sensors (e.g., capacitive force sensors) in the touch sensor. Additionally, as described above, the outer contact surface **126** defines an elastomeric surface (e.g., rubber) configured to, during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor, grip the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor. In this variation, the inner tip **130** can be formed of a non-conductive material and the system can implement the tip assembly **110** during a force and haptics measurement routine for a touch sensor.

(72) 4.2 Controller Operation

(73) In one implementation, the system **100** can via a controller **190** (e.g., driver, computer system **100**) execute a measurement routine to: maneuver (e.g., drag) the tip assembly **110** about a sequence of locations across the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor in a touch mode operation; and drive the probe—and thus the tip assembly **110**—at a target selection force greater than the target force threshold at a target location on the touch sensor surface in a haptic mode operation in order to trigger a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor during the measurement routine. Thus, during a single measurement routine, the system **100** can transition between: operation of the tip assembly **110** in touch mode in which the inner tip **130** is applied to the touch sensor surface, thus affecting electrical values across the touch sensor layer and the force sensor layer at the touch sensor; and operation of the tip assembly **110** in haptic mode in which each of the inner tip **130** and the outer tip **120** are in contact with the touch sensor surface in order to trigger a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor responsive to application of a target force magnitude at the touch sensor surface.

(74) In one implementation, during a first time period in the measurement routine corresponding to operation of the tip assembly **110** in touch mode, the system **100** can: drive an electrical signal (e.g., voltage signal) across the inner tip **130** to generate an electrical charge across the inner tip **130** contact surface; drive the probe, at a first target selection force less than a target force threshold, to apply the inner tip **130** at a particular region of the touch sensor surface and thus affect electrical values across the touch sensor layer and the force sensor layer at the touch sensor; and maneuver (e.g., drag) the inner tip **130** across a first sequence of locations at the particular region of the touch sensor surface.

(75) In the aforementioned implementation, during a second time period following the first time period in the measurement routine corresponding to operation of the tip assembly **110** in haptic mode, the system **100** can: maneuver the probe to locate the tip assembly **110** at a target location on the particular region of the touch sensor surface; couple the inner tip **130** to a reference potential (e.g., virtual ground) to cease electrical charge across the inner tip **130** contact surface; and drive the probe, at a second target selection force greater than the target selection force, to vertically translate the inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120** and thus apply each of the inner tip **130** and the outer tip **120** to the target location at the touch sensor surface and trigger a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor.

(76) In one implementation, the system can: generate an identification tag corresponding to a particular tip assembly **110** implemented by the system; and assign the identification tag to the tip assembly **110**; and track measurement routines, associated with the identification tag, executed by the system with the tip assembly **110** across multiple touch sensor units. In one example, in response to a quantity of measurement routines exceeding a threshold quantity (e.g., 1000 measurement cycles), the system can flag the identification tag associated with the tip assembly **110** for manual review by an operator.

(77) 4.2.1 Wired Connection

(78) In one implementation, the system **100** includes: the controller **190** arranged separate from the

tip assembly **110**, such as coupled to a boom supporting the probe and the tip assembly **110**; and a connector **160** extending from the tip assembly **110** and configured to electronically couple the controller **190** to enable the controller **190** to read vibration signals from the vibration sensor **142** at the tip assembly **110**.

(79) For example, the controller **190** can include a female connector configured to receive a male connector **160** extending from the tip assembly **110**. In this example, the male connector **160** includes: a connector circuit board including a set of connector pads configured to electronically couple to the female connector at the controller **190**; and a set of wires **162** extending from the set of connector pads on the connector circuit board and coupled (e.g., soldered) to the circuit board **140** arranged over the outer tip **120**. More specifically, the set of wires **162** can include: a first wire connected to a first output (e.g., X-axis vibration signal output) of the vibration sensor **142**; a second wire connected to a second output (e.g., Y-axis vibration signal output) of the vibration sensor **142**; and a third wire connected to a third output (e.g., Z-axis vibration signal output) of the vibration sensor **142**. Additionally, the set of wires **162** can include: a fourth wire configured to supply power to the circuit board **140**; a fifth wire connecting the vibration sensor **142** to a virtual ground; and a sixth wire connecting the inner tip **130** to a reference potential.

(80) In this example, the system **100** further includes a wire clamp **179**: interposed between the interface **170** and the enclosure **172** containing the tip assembly **110**; and configured to lead the set of wires **162** from the circuit board **140** outwardly from the enclosure **172**. Therefore, the system **100** can include: the controller **190** arranged separate from the tip assembly **110**; a tip assembly **110** arranged (e.g., coupled) to a probe; and a connector **160** coupling the controller **190** to the tip assembly **110**.

5. Measurement Routine

(81) During a calibration routine, once the touch sensor is loaded into the receptacle **132**, the controller **190** can retrieve a target selection force—from a set of target selection forces—assigned for the touch sensor surface, such as a first target selection force below the target selection force to calibrate touch inputs applied across the touch sensor surface and/or a second target selection force greater than the target selection force to calibrate (or “tune”) the touch sensor to detect “click” inputs of force magnitudes greater than this target force threshold across the touch sensor surface and to respond accordingly (e.g., by vibrating the touch sensor during a haptic feedback cycle). The controller **190** can also load a calibration path for the touch sensor, such as a preplanned serpentine or boustrophedonic path defining linear path sections offset according to a target calibration resolution (e.g., 10% of the total width of the touch sensor surface) and inset from the perimeter of the touch sensor surface (e.g., by 5% of the width of the touch sensor surface to produce nine parallel and offset linear path sections of the calibration path).

(82) In one implementation, the system **100** can execute a single calibration routine to generate: a response map representing touch, force, and haptic output at the touch sensor; calibrate input force thresholds across an area of the touch sensor based on the response map and thus compensate for manufacturing variance and manufacturing defects within the touch sensor in order to enable more accurate and repeatable detection and responses to inputs across the touch sensor surface as a function of applied force; and calibrate haptic feedback response across regions of a touch sensor surface based on the response map and thus compensate for haptic signal interference across the touch sensor surface generated during concurrent actuation of two or more haptic feedback modules.

(83) For example, during a first time period in the calibration routine, the system **100** can: drive an electrical signal (e.g., voltage signal) across the inner tip **130** to electrically charge the inner tip **130** contact surface; drive the probe, at a first target selection force less than a target force threshold, to apply the inner tip **130** at a particular region of the touch sensor surface and thus affect electrical values across the touch sensor layer and the force sensor layer at the touch sensor; and maneuver (e.g., drag) the inner tip **130** across a first sequence of locations at the particular region of the touch

sensor surface.

(84) Accordingly, the touch sensor can then capture a sequence of touch images representing: magnitudes of touch inputs detected on the touch sensor surface during the calibration routine; and magnitudes of forces detected on the touch sensor surface during the calibration routine. The touch sensor can then, responsive to completion of applying the tip assembly **110** across the sequence of locations at the touch sensor surface, transmit (e.g., wirelessly) the sequence of touch images to the system **100**. Furthermore, the system **100** can then: store the sequence of touch images within local memory; and retrieve the sequence of touch images from local memory to derive a response map.

(85) In this example, during a second time period in the calibration routine, the system **100** can, in response to completion of application of the tip assembly **110** across the sequence of locations: couple the inner tip **130** to a reference potential (e.g., virtual ground) to cease electrical charge across the inner tip **130** contact surface; and drive the probe, at a second target selection force greater than the target selection force, to vertically translate the inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120** and thus apply each of the inner tip **130** and the outer tip **120** to a final location—in the sequence of locations—at the touch sensor surface.

(86) Accordingly, the touch sensor can then: read a set of electrical values from the second array of drive and sense electrode pairs in the force sensor layer; interpret a force magnitude for the tip assembly **110** applied at the final location on the touch sensor surface; and, in response to application of a target force magnitude, trigger a haptic feedback cycle to oscillate the touch sensor surface.

(87) The system **100** can then: read a set of haptic feedback intensities from the vibration sensor **142** within the tip assembly **110** during the haptic feedback cycle; and generate a vibration image based on the set of haptic feedback intensities representing haptic response induced at the final location on the touch sensor surface during the haptic feedback cycle.

(88) Therefore, the system **100** can: fuse the sequence of touch images and the vibration images into a response map; and store the response map in local memory of the system **100**.

(89) 5.1 Measurement Routine: Interleaved Force+Haptics Testing

(90) In one implementation, the system **100** can execute a single calibration routine to: generate a response map representing touch, force, and haptic output at a target location on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor; calibrate input force thresholds at the target location on the touch sensor surface based on the response map; and calibrate haptic feedback response at the target location of the touch sensor surface based on the response map.

(91) For example, the system **100** can drive the probe, at a first target selection force less than a target force threshold, to apply the inner tip **130** at the target location on the touch sensor surface and thus affect electrical values across the touch sensor layer and the force sensor layer at the touch sensor. Accordingly, the touch sensor can then capture a touch image representing: magnitudes of touch inputs detected on the touch sensor surface during the calibration routine; and magnitudes of forces detected on the touch sensor surface during the calibration routine.

(92) Furthermore, the system **100** can then: couple the inner tip **130** to a reference potential (e.g., virtual ground); and drive the probe at a second target selection force, greater than the target selection force, to vertically translate the inner tip **130** within the outer tip **120** and thus apply each of the inner tip **130** and the outer tip **120** to the target location at the touch sensor surface.

Accordingly, the touch sensor can then: read a set of electrical values from the second array of drive and sense electrode pairs in the force sensor layer; interpret a force magnitude for the tip assembly **110** applied at the target location on the touch sensor surface; and, in response to application of a target force magnitude, trigger a haptic feedback cycle to oscillate the touch sensor surface. The system **100** can then: read a set of haptic feedback intensities from the vibration sensor **142** within the tip assembly **110** during the haptic feedback cycle; and generate a vibration image based on the set of haptic feedback intensities representing haptic response induced at the target location on the touch sensor surface during the haptic feedback cycle

(93) Therefore, the system **100** can fuse the touch image and the vibration image into a response map representing touch, force, and haptic output at the target location on the touch sensor surface thereby reducing passes of the tip assembly **110** across the same locations on the touch sensor surface during the calibration routine.

(94) 5.2 Measurement Routine: Localized Touch+Haptic Measurement

(95) In one implementation, the system **100** can: apply the tip assembly **110**, in the touch configuration, to a target location on the touch sensor surface at the first selection force to detect touch inputs across the touch sensor surface at the touch sensor; and apply the tip assembly **110**, in the haptic configuration, to the target location on the touch sensor surface at the second selection force to detect vibrations across the touch sensor surface during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor. Accordingly, the system **100** can then: retrieve touch data from the touch sensor during application of the tip assembly **110**, in the touch configuration, on the touch sensor surface; retrieve vibration data from the vibration sensor **142** during the haptic feedback cycle; and fuse the touch data and the vibration data to generate a response map corresponding to touch, force, and haptics response at the first location of the touch sensor surface.

(96) For example, the system **100** can, at a first time: apply the tip assembly **110**, in the touch configuration, to a target location on the touch sensor surface at the first selection force (e.g., 20 grams-force); and access a first touch image from the touch sensor representing a magnitude of force detected on the touch sensor surface by the touch sensor responsive to application of the first selection force on the touch sensor surface. Additionally, at a second time following the first time, the system **100** can: apply the tip assembly **110**, in the haptics configuration, to the target location on the touch sensor surface at the second selection force (e.g., 80 grams-force); trigger a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor to oscillate the touch sensor surface; and capture a first haptic waveform from the vibration sensor **142** representing detected vibrations at the target location on the touch sensor surface during the haptic feedback cycle. The system **100** can then: repeat the steps described above for a set of keypoints across the touch sensor surface to retrieve a set of touch images and a set of haptic waveforms corresponding to the set of keypoints on the touch sensor surface; and compile the set of touch images and the set of haptic waveforms into a response map representing touch, force, and haptics response across the touch sensor surface.

(97) Therefore, rather than sequentially executing a first measurement routine to measure touch response at the touch sensor and a second measurement routine to measure haptics response at the touch sensor, the system **100** can concurrently measure touch and haptics response at the touch sensor during a single measurement routine.

(98) 5.3 Measurement Routine: Haptic Keypoints+Measurement Path

(99) In one implementation, the system **100** can: during a first time period, apply (e.g., drag) the tip assembly **110**, in the touch configuration, along a measurement path on the touch sensor surface at the first selection force to detect touch inputs across the touch sensor surface at the touch sensor; and, during a second time period following the first time period, apply (e.g., couple) the tip assembly **110**, in the haptics configuration, across a set of keypoints on the touch sensor surface at the second selection force to detect vibrations across the touch sensor surface during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor. The system **100** can then, during the first time period: retrieve a sequence of touch images representing magnitudes of forces detected on the touch sensor surface by the touch sensor; and fuse the sequence of touch images into a touch response map representing magnitudes of forces detected on the touch sensor surface by the touch sensor responsive to application of the first selection force along the measurement path on the touch sensor surface. Additionally, during the second time period, the system **100** can: access a set of haptic waveforms captured by the vibration sensor **142** representing vibrations detected on the touch sensor surface; and fuse the set of haptic waveforms into a haptic response map representing haptic intensities detected on the touch sensor responsive to application of the second selection force on the touch sensor surface.

(100) Therefore, rather than relying on manual changing of the tip assembly 110, the system 100 can include a singular tip configured to transition between a touch measurement routine and a haptics measurement routine for the touch sensor.

(101) 5.4 Force Compensation Map

(102) In one implementation, such as described in U.S. Non-Provisional application Ser. No. 18/200,304, the touch sensor can: interpret force magnitudes (or representative values, such as sense electrode voltage or force-sensitive layer contact resistance) detected by drive electrode and sense electrode pairs in the sensor array that correspond to application of the target selection force at corresponding (e.g., adjacent, cospatial) locations on the touch sensor surface; and store these force magnitudes as threshold forces for detecting inputs at the target selection force at corresponding locations across the touch sensor surface, as shown in FIGS. 1 and 4B.

(103) For example, the touch sensor can: implement a common, fixed force model to transform resistance or voltage values read from the drive electrode and sense electrode pairs during scan cycles, within the calibration routine, into force magnitudes carried into these drive electrode and sense electrode pairs during these scan cycles; store these force magnitudes in touch images; compile these force-based touch images into a force-based response map; and directly store this force-based response map as the force compensation map such that the force compensation map defines uncorrected force magnitudes that correspond to application of the target selection force at discrete locations across the touch sensor surface.

(104) Alternatively, the touch sensor can: calculate a force offset, a scalar (i.e., linear) force correction function, or a nonlinear force correction function to convert the detected force magnitude of an input at a location on the touch sensor surface to a calibrated (or “true”) force magnitude based on the response map; write this force offset, scalar (i.e., linear) force correction function, or a nonlinear force correction function to a corresponding pixel or region of the force compensation map; and repeat this process for other pixels or regions represented in the response map, as described below.

(105) In a similar example, during a scan cycle, the touch sensor can: drive a set of drive electrodes in the touch sensor to a reference voltage; read a set of sense voltages from a set of sense electrodes in the touch sensor, wherein each sense electrode passes a voltage proportional to the reference voltage and a local contact resistance of the force-sensitive layer against the sense electrode, and wherein the force-sensitive layer exhibits changes in local contact resistance against the sense electrode as a function of force applied to the touch sensor surface; and then compile the set of sense voltages into a touch image for the scan cycle. In this example, the touch sensor can then represent magnitudes of voltages passed by the set of sense electrodes—responsive to application of the target selection force on the touch sensor surface by the probe during the calibration routine—in pixels representing corresponding drive electrode and sense electrode pairs in a response map. The touch sensor can then generate a force compensation map that defines magnitudes of voltages—carried over from the response map—as threshold voltages for detecting inputs of force magnitudes greater than the target selection at corresponding locations on the touch sensor surface. More specifically, in this example, the touch sensor can: generate a voltage-based response map; and directly store this voltage-based response map as the force compensation map such that the force compensation map defines uncorrected voltage magnitudes that correspond to application of the target selection force at discrete locations across the touch sensor surface.

(106) Alternatively, the touch sensor can: calculate a voltage offset, a scalar (i.e., linear) voltage correction function, or a nonlinear voltage correction function to convert the detected voltage of an input at a location on the touch sensor surface to a calibrated (or “true”) voltage based on the response map; write this voltage offset, scalar (i.e., linear) voltage correction function, or nonlinear voltage correction function to a corresponding pixel or region of the force compensation map; and repeat this process for other pixels or regions represented in the response map, as described below.

(107) (Additionally or alternatively, the touch sensor can: store these voltage offsets, scalar (i.e.,

linear) voltage correction functions, or nonlinear voltage correction functions in a point cloud or other, more compact data container; and recall all or parts of this point cloud other data container to correct force magnitudes of inputs on the touch sensor surface during operation.)

(108) 5.5 Haptic Output Calibration

(109) In one implementation, such as described in U.S. Non-Provisional application Ser. No. 18/141,317, the touch sensor is configured to receive controlled input forces of a predefined magnitude (e.g., fixed calibration magnitude) over a set of discrete locations on the touch sensor surface during a calibration cycle. Concurrent with each application of the calibration force, the controller **190** within the touch sensor can trigger a sequence of vibration cycles for the first haptic feedback module to oscillate the touch sensor surface. The sequence of vibration cycles defines a sequence of oscillating voltage cycles containing instructions for voltage amplitude, phase off-set, and time duration for the voltage cycle delivered to the haptic feedback module. The touch system **100** can then sample haptic feedback intensity (e.g., waveforms, peak to peak accelerations, acoustics) for the discrete regions on the touch sensor surface in order to observe how each vibration cycle in the sequence of vibration cycles oscillates the touch sensor surface on a particular discrete region. For example, for a particular region on the touch sensor surface, the sequence of vibration cycles can increment voltage amplitudes following each cycle to observe how varying amplitudes oscillate the touch sensor surface on a particular discrete region.

(110) The controller **190** can interpret a maximum haptic feedback intensity (e.g., maximum peak to peak acceleration) and a minimum haptic feedback intensity (e.g., minimum peak to peak acceleration) for a particular region on the touch sensor surface based on the sampled set of haptic feedback intensities for the particular calibration region. Furthermore, the controller **190** can select the target haptic intensity based on a desired haptic feedback intensity for the calibration region. For example, to increase haptic feedback intensities across all calibration regions on the touch sensor surface, the controller **190** can select a target haptic feedback intensity at the maximum haptic feedback intensity for all calibration regions on the touch sensor surface. The controller **190** can then interpret a first vibration cycle for the haptic feedback module in order to deliver the target haptic feedback intensity to the particular calibration region based on the sampled set of haptic feedback intensities and the sequence of vibration cycles. The first vibration cycle contains instructions for a first oscillating voltage cycle containing a first voltage amplitude, a first phase off-set, and a first-time duration delivered to the haptic feedback module to achieve the desired target haptic feedback response.

(111) The controller **190** can generate vibration images for the calibration regions on the touch sensor surface to apply targeted haptic feedback response across the touch sensor surface. For example, for a touch input interpreted on a first region on the touch sensor surface corresponding to the first calibration region, the touch system **100** can then: access the first vibration image for the first region containing a first vibration cycle defining a target haptic feedback intensity for the first region; and trigger the first vibration cycle for the haptic feedback module to deliver the target haptic feedback intensity to the first region on the touch sensor surface. The controller **190** can then compile each of the vibration images for each of the calibration regions on the touch sensor surface into a vibration template defining haptic feedback intensities across all regions on the touch sensor surface.

6. Multiple Probes

(112) In one variation, the system **100** includes multiple discrete and offset probes, each supported by one boom (e.g., one linear actuator), each including a tip assembly **110**, and coupled to one force (or pressure) sensor. In this variation, the system **100** can implement the foregoing methods and techniques to concurrently drive the set of probes into contact with the touch sensor surface at the target selection force, such as along contiguous segments of the calibration path or at discrete groups of waypoints across the touch sensor surface. For example, the system **100** can include ten probes located at a common, fixed pitch distance spanning the width of the touch sensor surface;

accordingly, the system **100** can simultaneously sweep the ten probes linearly along a single, contiguous linear calibration path across the touch sensor surface.

(113) However, the system **100** can include any other quantity or arrangement of probes and can sweep these probes across the touch sensor surface according to any other calibration path.

(114) The system **100s** and methods described herein can be embodied and/or implemented at least in part as a machine configured to receive a computer-readable medium storing computer-readable instructions. The instructions can be executed by computer-executable components integrated with the application, applet, host, server, network, website, communication service, communication interface, hardware/firmware/software elements of a user computer or mobile device, wristband, smartphone, or any suitable combination thereof. Other system **100s** and methods of the embodiment can be embodied and/or implemented at least in part as a machine configured to receive a computer-readable medium storing computer-readable instructions. The instructions can be executed by computer-executable components integrated by computer-executable components integrated with apparatuses and networks of the type described above. The computer-readable medium can be stored on any suitable computer readable media such as RAMs, ROMs, flash memory, EEPROMs, optical devices (CD or DVD), hard drives, floppy drives, or any suitable device. The computer-executable component can be a processor but any suitable dedicated hardware device can (alternatively or additionally) execute the instructions.

(115) As a person skilled in the art will recognize from the previous detailed description and from the figures and claims, modifications and changes can be made to the embodiments of the invention without departing from the scope of this invention as defined in the following claims.

Claims

1. A system for characterizing touch and haptics responses of surfaces, the system comprising: a tip assembly comprising: an outer tip comprising: a distal end; an aperture proximal the distal end; and an outer contact surface arranged about the aperture; a conductive inner tip: arranged concentrically within the outer tip; extending through the aperture of the outer tip; and comprising an inner contact surface; a circuit board adjacent a proximal end of the outer tip; a vibration sensor arranged on the circuit board and configured to output vibration signals representing vibrations transferred into the outer tip and into the conductive inner tip; a spring element: interposed between the circuit board and the conductive inner tip; coupling the conductive inner tip to a reference potential; and configured to yield responsive to a force applied to the conductive inner tip to translate the conductive inner tip within the outer tip; operable in a first configuration during application of the conductive inner tip on a touch sensor surface of a touch sensor at a first selection force, the inner contact surface offset vertically from the outer contact surface and the conductive inner tip effecting electrical values across drive and sense electrode pairs in the touch sensor in the first configuration; and operable in a second configuration during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor in response to application of the conductive inner tip on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at a second selection force greater than the first selection force, the inner contact surface coplanar with the outer contact surface and the outer tip and the conductive inner tip transferring vibrations from the touch sensor surface into the vibration sensor in the second configuration.

2. The system of claim 1, further comprising a controller configured to: during application of the tip assembly at a first location on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at the first selection force in the first configuration: access a first touch image, from the touch sensor, representing a touch input detected on the touch sensor surface; and access a first force image, from the touch sensor, representing a force magnitude of the touch input detected on the touch sensor surface at the first location; during application of the tip assembly at the first location on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at the second selection force in the second configuration, capture a first haptic

waveform at the vibration sensor representing vibrations across the touch sensor surface during the haptic feedback cycle; and fuse the first touch image, the first force image, and the first haptic waveform into a response map for the first location of the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor.

3. The system of claim 1: wherein the conductive inner tip comprises: a receptacle comprising a base defining the inner contact surface; and a lip arranged about a proximal end of the receptacle; wherein the outer tip comprises: an inner wall; and a platform arranged about the inner wall and configured to support the lip of the receptacle to locate the inner tip concentrically within the outer tip and extending from the aperture of the outer tip; and wherein the spring element: is arranged within the receptacle of the conductive inner tip; and comprises: a first end electrically coupled to the base of the receptacle; and a second end, opposite the first end, in contact to an electrical pad on the circuit board, the electrical pad coupled to the reference potential.

4. The system of claim 3: wherein the tip assembly is operable in the first configuration during application of the conductive inner tip on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at the first selection force, the spring element configured to yield responsive to application of the first selection force at the conductive inner tip to: offset the lip of the receptacle from the platform to partially translate the conductive inner tip within the outer tip in the first configuration; and locate the inner contact surface of the conductive inner tip vertically offset from the outer contact surface of the outer tip in the first configuration; and wherein the tip assembly is operable in the second configuration during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor in response to application of the conductive inner tip on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at a second selection force greater than the first selection force, the spring element configured to yield responsive to application of the second selection force at the conductive inner tip to: offset the lip of the receptacle from the platform to vertically translate the conductive inner tip within the outer tip in the first configuration; couple the lip of the receptacle to a bottom side of the circuit board in the first configuration; and locate the inner contact surface of the conductive inner tip coplanar with the outer contact surface of the outer tip in the first configuration.

5. The system of claim 3, wherein the conductive inner tip further comprises a guide ring arranged within the receptacle and configured to vertically constrain the spring element within the receptacle.

6. The system of claim 1: further comprising: an interface configured to couple a distal end of a probe; and an enclosure: coupling the interface; and containing the tip assembly, the outer tip and the inner tip of the tip assembly extending from a bottom end of the enclosure; and wherein the tip assembly further comprises: a top cover arranged over the circuit board and the vibration sensor; and a spacer element interposed between the interface and the top cover of the tip assembly and configured to dampen vibrations transferred from the interface to the vibration sensor.

7. The system of claim 1: wherein the tip assembly is operable in the first configuration during application of the conductive inner tip on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at the first selection force, less than a fifty gram-force, the inner contact surface contacting the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor surface and the outer contact surface offset from the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor surface in the first configuration; and wherein the tip assembly is operable in the second configuration during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor in response to application of the conductive inner tip on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at a second selection force, greater than a fifty-gram force, the inner contact surface coplanar with the outer contact surface in the first configuration, and the inner contact surface and the outer contact surface contacting the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor in the first configuration.

8. The system of claim 1: wherein the inner contact surface defines a first coefficient of friction; wherein the outer contact surface defines a second coefficient of friction, greater than the first coefficient of friction, and configured to retain a local region of the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor.

9. The system of claim 1, further comprising a controller configured to: during application of the

tip assembly along a measurement path on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at the first selection force in the first configuration: access a sequence of touch images representing magnitudes of forces detected on the touch sensor surface by the touch sensor; and fuse the sequence of touch images into a touch response map representing magnitudes of forces detected on the touch sensor surface by the touch sensor responsive to application of the first selection force on the touch sensor surface; and during application of the tip assembly across a set of keypoints on the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor at the second selection force in the second configuration: access a set of haptic waveforms captured by the vibration sensor representing vibrations detected on the touch sensor surface; and fuse the set of haptic waveforms into a haptic response map representing haptic intensities detected on the touch sensor responsive to application of the second selection force on the touch sensor surface.

10. The system of claim 1: wherein the outer tip further comprises: a first support region at a proximal end of the outer tip; a second support region, opposite the first support region, at the proximal end of the outer tip; and a channel interposed between the first support region and the second support region; wherein the circuit board comprises: a first board section extending over the first support region of the outer tip; a second board section, opposite the first board section, extending over the second support region of the outer tip; and a center board section: interposed between the first board section and the second board section; and extending over the channel of the outer tip to enclose the conductive inner tip within the outer tip; and wherein the vibration sensor: is arranged on the center board section of the circuit board; and is configured to output vibration signals: transferred from the conductive inner tip to the center board section of the circuit board; and transferred from the outer tip to the first board section and the second board section of the circuit board.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the spring element: is interposed between the conductive inner tip and the center section of the circuit board adjacent the vibration sensor; and configured to transfer vibrations in the conductive inner tip to the vibration sensor on the circuit board.

12. The system of claim 1: wherein the outer contact surface: defines an annular contact surface proximal the distal end of the outer tip; and is formed of an elastomeric material configured to maintain contact with a local region the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor during the haptic feedback cycle; and wherein the inner contact surface: defines a circular contact surface concentric with the annular contact surface of the outer tip; and is formed of a conductive material configured to effect electrical values across drive and sense electrode pairs at the touch sensor.

13. The system of claim 1, wherein the spring element comprises a conductive foam material interposed between the circuit board and the conductive inner tip.

14. The system of claim 1, wherein the vibration sensor comprises a multi-axis vibration sensor configured to: output a first vibration signal representing vibrations transferred into the outer tip and the conductive inner tip within a vibration plane defined by the touch sensor surface; and output a second vibration signal representing vibrations transferred into the outer tip and the conductive inner tip orthogonal the vibration plane defined by the touch sensor surface.

15. The system of claim 1: wherein the outer tip: comprises a channel extending from the proximal end to the distal end; and defines a tip axis; wherein the circuit board extends over the channel of the outer tip; wherein the spring element: is arranged within the channel of the outer tip aligned to the tip axis; and is configured to locate the conductive inner tip offset the circuit board in response to absence of an applied force to the conductive inner tip; and is configured to yield in response to application of the second selection force at the conductive inner tip that vertically translates the conductive inner tip within the channel of the outer tip to contact the circuit board.

16. A system for characterizing touch and haptics responses of surfaces, the system comprising: a tip assembly comprising: an outer tip comprising: a distal end; an aperture proximal the distal end; and an outer contact surface arranged about the aperture; a conductive inner tip: arranged concentrically within the outer tip; extending through the aperture of the outer tip; and comprising

an inner contact surface; a circuit board adjacent a proximal end of the outer tip; a vibration sensor arranged on the circuit board and configured to output vibration signals representing vibrations transferred into the outer tip and into the conductive inner tip; a spring element: interposed between the circuit board and the conductive inner tip; coupling the conductive inner tip to a reference potential; and configured to yield responsive to a force, exceeding a target selection force, applied to the conductive inner tip to translate the conductive inner tip within the outer tip; a controller configured to: during application of the tip assembly at a first location on a touch sensor surface of a touch sensor at a first selection force, less than the target selection force, access a first touch image, from the touch sensor, representing a force magnitude detected on the touch sensor surface; during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor in response to application of the conductive inner tip and the outer tip at the first location on the touch sensor surface at a second selection force, exceeding the target selection force, capture a haptic waveform, at the vibration sensor, representing vibrations detected across the touch sensor surface during the haptic feedback cycle; and fuse the touch image and the haptic waveform into a response map of the touch sensor.

17. The system of claim 16: wherein the conductive inner tip comprises: a receptacle comprising a base defining the inner contact surface; and a lip arranged about a proximal end of the receptacle; wherein the outer tip comprises: an inner wall; and a platform arranged about the inner wall and configured to support the lip of the receptacle to locate the inner tip concentrically within the outer tip and extending from the aperture of the outer tip; and wherein the spring element: is arranged within the receptacle of the conductive inner tip; and comprises: a first end electrically coupled to the base of the receptacle; and a second end, opposite the first end, in contact to an electrical pad on the circuit board, the electrical pad coupled to the reference potential.

18. The system of claim 16: wherein the inner contact surface defines a first coefficient of friction; wherein the outer contact surface defines a second coefficient of friction, greater than the first coefficient of friction, and configured to retain a local region of the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor during a haptic feedback cycle at the touch sensor.

19. The system of claim 16: wherein the outer contact surface: defines an annular contact surface proximal the distal end of the outer tip; and is formed of an elastomeric material configured to maintain contact with a local region the touch sensor surface of the touch sensor during the haptic feedback cycle; and wherein the inner contact surface: defines a circular contact surface concentric with the annular contact surface of the outer tip; and is formed of a conductive material configured to effect electrical values across drive and sense electrode pairs at the touch sensor.

20. A tip assembly comprising: an outer tip comprising: a distal end; an aperture proximal the distal end; and an outer contact surface arranged about the aperture; an inner tip: arranged concentrically within the outer tip; extending through the aperture of the outer tip; and comprising an inner contact surface; a circuit board arranged adjacent a proximal end of the outer tip; a vibration sensor arranged on the circuit board and configured to output vibration signals representing vibrations transferred into the outer tip and into the inner tip; a spring element: interposed between the circuit board and the inner tip; configured to locate the inner contact surface vertically offset from the outer contact surface in response to absence of an applied force at the inner tip; and configured to yield in response to application of a force, exceeding a target selection force, at the inner tip that vertically translates the inner tip within the outer tip and locates the inner contact surface coplanar with the outer contact surface.
